
email: erlindemeertens@protonmail.com

Current position

since 4/2025 Postdoc Linguistics, Meertens Institute / KNAW-HUC / NL-Lab
Cow language project

Education

2016-2021 PhD in Linguistics, Universität Konstanz
Dissertation: Alternative Questions – from Surface to Meaning
Committee: Maribel Romero, María Biezma, Matthijs Westera

2014-2016 Master of Arts Linguistics, Universiteit Utrecht

2012-2014 Bachelor of Arts Linguistics, Universiteit Utrecht

Areas of Expertise

Non-human animal interaction: non-human animal interaction, cows, multimodality, ethnographic fieldwork, non-human animal speech acts

Semantics/pragmatics: questions, imperatives, discourse, alternatives, focus, prosody-interface

Crosslinguistic syntax/semantics: Q-particles, questions, bias

Publications

Romero, M., & Meertens, E. (2022). Q-particles and islands in Sinhala wh-and polar questions. *Acta Linguistica Academica*, 69(1), 104-127.

Meertens, E. & Jordanoska, I. (2021). The pragmatic effects of Macedonian li: an experimental study. *Formal Approaches to Slavic Linguistics* 13.

Beltrama, A., Meertens, E., & Romero, M. (2020). Alternative Questions: Distinguishing between Negated and Complementary Disjuncts. *Semantics and Pragmatics*, 13, 5. DOI: 10.3765/sp.13.5.

Meertens, E. (2020). How prosody disambiguates between Alternative and Polar Questions. In J. J. Schlöder, D. McHugh and F. Roelofsen, eds., *Proceedings of the 22nd Amsterdam Colloquium*, pages 299-308.

Meertens, E., Egger, S., & Romero, M. (2019). Multiple accent in alternative questions. In M.T. Espinal, E. Castroviejo, M. Leonetti, L. McNally and C. Real-Puigdollers, eds., *Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung*, vol.2, pages 179-195.

Meertens, E. (2018). Prosody in disjunctive questions: Introducing class. *University of Pennsylvania Working Papers in Linguistics*, 25(1), 21.

Beltrama, A., Meertens, E., & Romero, M. (2018a). Alternative questions between logic and discourse. An experimental study. In Proceedings of the 53rd Annual Meeting of the Chicago Linguistic Society (CLS53).

Beltrama, A., Meertens, E., & Romero, M. (2018b). Decomposing cornering effects: An experimental study. In U. Sauerland and S. Solt, eds., Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung 22, vol. 1, pages 175-190.

Presentations

Invited talks

Non-human animal speech acts: The case of dairy cows (July 2025). Leibniz Universität Hannover, Sommerkolloquium Germanistik.

Plateau Rise in Disjunctive Questions (2018). Universiteit van Amsterdam (UvA), Institute of Logic, Language and Computation, Inquisitive Semantics Seminar.

Q-Particles in Alternative Questions (2018). Universität Wien, Fachbereich Linguistik, Semantik Kolloquium.

Conference talks

What non-human animals do with language: analyzing dairy cow interactions as speech-acts. (2026) Pragmasophia. University of Messina, May 11-14.

Towards a better analysis. (with Felix Frühauf) (2026)
A Germanic Sandwich 10. Freie Universität Berlin, May 7-8.

Silent Questions (2026).
Polar Questions Across Languages. University of Göttingen, April 29-30.

Focus marking strategies in polar questions in Macedonian (with Izabela Jordanoska) (2020).
Workshop Focus alternatives: Theoretical and empirical perspectives. Humboldt Universität Berlin, February 27-28.

Crosslinguistic variation in a minor sentence type: Melioratives in Dutch and German (with Sven Lauer) (2018).
Workshop on Non Canonical Imperatives, Humboldt Universität Berlin, May 25-26.

The Interpretive Contribution of *li* in Macedonian (with Izabela Jordanoska) (2018) .
Balkan Languages and Dialects: Corpus-Based and Quantitative Studies. St. Petersburg. October 18-20.

‘Enriching a grammatical database with intelligent links to linguistic resources’ with (Frank Landsbergen, Ton van der Wouden, Jorik van Engeland and Sylvia Wijsman) (2015)
Demo at CLARIN-conference, Wrocław, October 16th.

Teaching Experience

2026	Supervising BA-thesis on alternative questions University College Utrecht
2026	Second reader BA-thesis on biased questions University College Utrecht

2019 Semantics I (Co-instructing with Maribel Romero)
 Universität Konstanz
2018 Semantics I (Tutor)
 Universität Konstanz

Conference Organisation

2026 The Animal Turn in Linguistics
 Lorentz Centre, Leiden

2017 TripleA 5
 Universität Konstanz

2017 Meaning in non-canonical questions
 Universität Konstanz

Science Communication

2026 Lecture Animal Languages
 Summerschool *Language and Meaning are Everywhere*
 Internationale School Voor Wijsbegeerte, Leusden

2026 Participation Panel on Animal Languages
 Taalfeest (Onze Taal), Antwerpen

Non-academic Working Experience

4/2024-3/2025 German teacher secondary education, John Dewey College, Den Haag

7/2023-10/2023 Project Manager: Research Data Infrastructures
 Bavarian State Library, Munich

03/2022-06/2023 Data Linguist
 StepStone, Munich

04/2021-12/2021 Software Developer
 Accenture, Munich

Language Proficiencies

Dutch (native), English (fluent), German (fluent)

Technical Skills

Research: Python, R, Praat, LaTeX

Corporate: Python, Java, SQL, Git.